

Pemetrexed: Alimta, Pemfexy, Pemrydi RTU

Effective Date: 12/5/2022

Revision Date(s): 12/5/2022; 11/7/2023; 12/29/2023; 5/23/24; 8/5/2024; 9/24/2024; 11/14/2024; 1/1/2025; 07/01/2025; 10/1/2025

Review Date: 10/1/2025

Policy type: Medical Necessity

Line of Business: All GEHA Commercial Medical Plans

Authorizations are issued for 6 (six) months, unless the ordering physician requests a different timespan or the patients' unique circumstance, or condition supports the medical necessity for a different authorization timeframe. Reauthorization requests are reviewed for efficacy, safety and tolerability.

Preference	Requires Prior Auth	Drug Name	HCPCS Code	Description
PREFERRED	Yes	Pemetrexed (Axtle)	J9292	Injection, pemetrexed dipotassium, 10 mg
Non-Preferred	Yes	Pemetrexed (Hospira)	J9294	Injection, pemetrexed (hospira) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg
PREFERRED	Yes	Pemetrexed (Accord)	J9296	Injection, pemetrexed (accord) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg
Non-Preferred	Yes	Pemetrexed (Sandoz)	J9297	Injection, pemetrexed (sandoz), not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg
Non-Preferred	Yes	Pemetrexed (Alimta)	J9305	Injection, pemetrexed, not otherwise specified, 10 mg
Non-Preferred	Yes	Pemetrexed (Teva)	J9314	Injection, pemetrexed (teva) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg
PREFERRED	Yes	Pemetrexed (Bluepoint)	J9322	Injection, pemetrexed (bluepoint) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg
Non-Preferred	Yes	Pemetrexed ditromethamine (Hospira)	J9323	Injection, pemetrexed ditromethamine, 10 mg
Non-Preferred	Yes	Pemfexy	J9304	Injection, pemetrexed (pemfexy), 10 mg
Non-Preferred	Yes	Pemrydi RTU	J9324	Injection, pemetrexed (pemrydi rtu), 10 mg

- Members must have documentation of a contraindication, failure, or intolerance to any of the preferred agents (or their 505(b)(2) equivalents) prior to approval of a non-preferred product, when clinically appropriate.
- Preferred product requirements apply to new starts ONLY.
- Step Therapy applies to all overlapping compendia supported indications/regimens

Universal Approval Criteria:

Unless otherwise noted, the review criteria used by OncoHealth to determine medical necessity for anticancer treatments and supportive agents include, but is not limited to:

- National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN) - use consistent with NCCN recommendations carrying a Category 1 or 2A level of evidence; **OR**
- United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling - new drugs or regimens (combinations of drugs) consistent with all components of the product labeling; **OR**
- Indications not included in the official FDA labeling or recommended by NCCN (Category 1 or 2A level of evidence) may be considered if determined to be medically necessary per one or more of the following compendia:
 - Clinical Pharmacology (Strong For); **OR**
 - Wolters Kluwer Lexi-Drugs® (Level A); **OR**
- Other uses of drugs and biologics may be considered medically necessary if supported as safe and effective according to peer-reviewed articles from one of the following journals:
 - American Journal of Medicine; Annals of Internal Medicine; Annals of Oncology; Annals of Surgical Oncology; Biology of Blood and Marrow Transplantation; Blood; Bone Marrow Transplantation; British Journal of Cancer; British Journal of Hematology; British Medical Journal; Cancer; Clinical Cancer Research; Drugs; European Journal of Cancer (formerly the European Journal of Cancer and Clinical Oncology); Gynecologic Oncology; International Journal of Radiation, Oncology, Biology, and Physics; The Journal of the American Medical Association; Journal of Clinical Oncology; Journal of the National Cancer Institute; Journal of the National Comprehensive Cancer Network (NCCN); Journal of Urology; Lancet; Lancet Oncology; Leukemia; The New England Journal of Medicine; Radiation Oncology;
 - **Meeting abstracts and case reports are excluded from consideration;**
- Non-standard protocols may be approved based on unique clinical circumstances;
- Dose and frequency should be consistent with United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling, National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN), or indication specific peer-reviewed literature;
- In the instance that a request is made for drug(s) that was (were) previously tried (including in the same pharmacologic class or with the same mechanism of action) and such drug(s) was (were) discontinued due to a lack of efficacy the request may be subject to an off-label review for medical necessity unless supported by the NCCN or high quality literature (prospective phase 2 or 3 studies published as full manuscripts in a CMS-supported journal).

Billing

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Pemetrexed (Axtle)	J9292	Injection, pemetrexed dipotassium, 10 mg
Pemetrexed (Hospira)	J9294	Injection, pemetrexed (hospira) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg
Pemetrexed (Accord)	J9296	Injection, pemetrexed (accord) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg

Drug Name	HCP Code	Description
Pemetrexed (Sandoz)	J9297	Injection, pemetrexed (sandoz), not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg
Pemfexy	J9304	Injection, pemetrexed (pemfexy), 10 mg
Alimta	J9305	Injection, pemetrexed, not otherwise specified, 10 mg
Pemetrexed (Teva)	J9314	Injection, pemetrexed (teva) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10mg
Pemetrexed (Bluepoint)	J9322	Injection, pemetrexed (bluepoint) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg
Pemetrexed ditromethamine (Hospira)	J9323	Injection, pemetrexed ditromethamine, 10 mg
Pemrydi RTU	J9324	Injection, pemetrexed (pemrydi rtu), 10 mg

References

1. Alimta [package insert]. Eli Lilly and Co. Indianapolis, IN. Available at: https://www.accessdata.fda.gov/drugsatfda_docs/label/2009/021462s021lbl.pdf
2. Pemfexy [package insert]. Eagle Pharmaceuticals, Inc., Woodcliff Lake, NJ. Available at: <https://www.pemfexy.com/storage/2022/12/PEMFEXY-pemetrexed-injection-US-PI-12-2022.pdf>
3. Pemetrexed [package insert]. Hospira, Inc., Lake Forest, IL. Available at: <https://labeling.pfizer.com/ShowLabeling.aspx?id=17370>
4. Pemetrexed [package insert]. Accord Healthcare, Inc., Durham, NC. Available at: https://www.accordhealthcare.us/wp-content/uploads/2022/11/PI-Pemetrexed-Liq-vials_July-2022.pdf
5. Pemetrexed [package insert]. Sandoz Inc., Princeton, NJ. Available at: https://www.accessdata.fda.gov/drugsatfda_docs/label/2023/214657s003lbl.pdf
6. Pemetrexed [package insert]. Teva Pharmaceuticals. Parsippany, NJ. Available at: <https://dailymed.nlm.nih.gov/dailymed/drugInfo.cfm?setid=8b660f68-b770-4e0a-b2f9-25e663deecc3>
7. Pemetrexed [package insert]. Qilu Pharmaceuticals (Hainan) Co., Ltd. Haikou, China. Available at: <https://dailymed.nlm.nih.gov/dailymed/drugInfo.cfm?setid=c9f34c00-1176-4f44-8cff-bae5bdc0c40f>
8. Pemetrexed ditromethamine [package insert]. Hospira, Inc., Lake Forest, IL. Available at: https://www.accessdata.fda.gov/drugsatfda_docs/label/2022/208746s000lbl.pdf
9. Pemrydi RTU [package insert]. Amneal Pharmaceuticals, LLC., Bridgewater, Nj. Available at: <https://dailymed.nlm.nih.gov/dailymed/fda/fdaDrugXsl.cfm?setid=0f006b06-ab85-423d-ba0c-dfc3fc25844e&type=display>
10. Pemetrexed. NCCN Drugs and Biologics Compendium. Available at: https://www.nccn.org/professionals/drug_compendium/content/
11. Referenced with permission from the NCCN Clinical Practice Guidelines in Oncology (NCCN Guidelines®). National Comprehensive Cancer Network, Inc. 2025. All rights reserved. Accessed September 12, 2025. To view the most recent and complete version of the guideline, go online to NCCN.org.

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Date	Updates
11/7/2023	Updated Step Therapy; Addition of HCPCS; Addition of Universal Criteria; Updated references
12/29/23	Added J9324
5/23/24	Annual Review. Universal Criteria updated.
8/5/2024	Added pemetrexed Apotex 505 (b)(2), Updated Universal Criteria, Disclaimer, approval timeframe per compliance 7.2024
9/19/2024	Policy adopted by GEHA; document updated for universal accessibility.
11/10/2024	Updated GEHA logo
11/14/2024	Addition of new HCPCS effective 1/1/2025 pemetrexed avyxa 505 (b) (2); included Alimta brand as PA exempt under J9305 entry for pemetrexed
1/17/2025	Updated status of Hospira, Sandoz and Teva to non-preferred; accessibility updates to format
07/01/2025	Updated HCPCS Description for J9292; Updated ST Criteria related to trial of 505(b)(2) generics
10/1/2025	Annual Review – removed J9999 – approved by OH P&T
10/23/25	Corrected status of Hospira to non-preferred to align with the change made 1/17/25.